international agencies, are evidence of a new kind of nascent politics. As in the case of the politics of policymaking, these practices contain within them glimmers of the political. But cognizant of law's intimate relationship with violence, Crouch warns against unrealistic expectations that the solution to conflict in Myanmar is more legislation. Law as an answer to conflict always brings with it the possibility of diminishing the political through the exercise or threat of violence.

One way that law can act in response to conflict through nonpolitical means is by de-activating the political through the removal of certain issues from the domain in which they can be debated openly and aggressively, or through the removal of people who would otherwise speak and act on those issues from that domain. In modern times, the most effective way law has acted to this end has been to exclude from the political community people who would otherwise belong to it; to refuse them standing or voice through denial or revocation of citizenship (Cheesman 2015a, p. 110), such that a person thereby "ceases to be politically relevant" (Agamben 1998, p. 139). A politically irrelevant person is imperiled not because they are denied legal protections that they might otherwise have had but more specifically because the only possible response to conflict with a person bereft of political qualities can be nonpolitical.

This is why the anti-Muslim and more specifically anti-Rohingya project, aimed at making stateless hundreds of thousands of people in the country's west is so startling and significant.[6] The problem that people who are either self ascribed or are identified as Rohingya — or in the terminology of state, Bengali — encounter is not just that they have had their voting rights cancelled (see Than Tun 2016), although the denial of these rights is symptomatic. Rather, it is that having been denied a place in the political community, the members of this population lack any distinctive political qualities at all. Rendered politically irrelevant, even if the Rohingya can speak, they are not heard (Cheesman 2015b, p. 148).

Ironically, this removal of the Rohingya from the political community "Myanmar" neither liberates their opponents, nor restores to them something of the political that they might have lost or lacked were the Rohingya politically relevant. In fact, it achieves the opposite outcome, since it denies the very possibility of a political solution to conflict, reducing relations between the two communities to physical violence.

Matt Schissler (2016) writes evocatively about how Islamophobes in Myanmar do not feel any more secure or any less fearful for having